

All about tablets in the modern age of foldable phones!

Lenovo's **Sumati Sahgal** tells us about evolving consumer trends in the tablet space and tablets' relevance in the age of foldables

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Lenovo has been among the few companies at the forefront of tablet innovation and development in India. The company has launched several tablets in the past couple of years including their first 5G tablet offering – the Lenovo Tab P11 5G. There have been other recent launches such as the Lenovo Tab M9 as well, which is touted to be popular amongst students and working individuals. It is no surprise that Lenovo emerged as the leading company in the 5G tablet market in India in 2022, as per a CMR report. On the heels of these recent launches, we spoke to Sumati Sahgal, Head - Tablets and Smart Devices, Lenovo India, about the tablet ecosystem in India, the manufacturing of tablets locally, and the relevance of tablets in the era of foldables. It was quite an insightful discussion that you can read in detail below.

Q Lenovo recently launched the Tab M9 and launched the Tab P11 earlier this year. Can you give us a brief about these latest launches and how Lenovo approaches the tablet segment in India?

A Lenovo has always been a key player in the tablet market, and it remains one of our core business lines. Our approach is centred around providing the right products that align with customer requirements while incorporating inno-



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vative features. We constantly strive to meet the ever-changing needs of tablet users in India. Let's talk about the recent launches, starting with the Tab M9. With the Tab M9, we introduced a product that provides a fully immersive experience with a full HD display and a powerful Qualcomm Snapdragon processor.

Tablets serve different purposes for consumers. Entertainment has become a prominent tablet use case, demanding larger screens. With the new M9 we seek to meet the functional needs of the user on the go, the P11 caters to the infotainment needs. This is our premium offering with 5G capabilities. As 5G networks roll out across the country, there is a growing demand for devices that can

provide an enhanced content consumption experience. Customers want larger screen sizes, excellent display quality, and the ability to connect beyond 4G networks. This is where the Tab P11 fills the gap. The pen adds to the comprehensive range of accessories and higher storage option variants make this a complete offering.

Lenovo's approach to the tablet segment in India revolves around understanding customer requirements and delivering innovative products. Our recent launches, the Tab M9 and Tab P11 5G, showcase our commitment to offering a diverse range of tablets that cater to different use cases and meet the evolving needs of consumers.

Q Can you give us some insight into Lenovo's tablet retail presence in India? Is it all online or a mix of online and offline? If yes, which stream accounts for a larger percentage of sales in the tablets category?

A From a category perspective, we have observed a significant shift in consumer buying behaviour towards a blend of online and large-format retail. While Online buying became pronounced during the pandemic, a considerable portion of consumers still prefer offline stores where they can experience products. At Lenovo, we recognise the importance of making our products available at the point of sale where consumers conduct their research and make purchasing decisions. Online platforms have become crucial for consumers as a primary research tool. Therefore, online presence is vital for us. Nonetheless, we also maintain a strong offline presence through organized retail partnerships and our Lenovo exclusive stores. This allows us to cater to customers across various channels and provide them with opportunities to experience our products firsthand.

In terms of partnerships, we collaborate with key players in the market, including leading online retailers and offline chains. We have observed positive